

ProfileSA — MVP Scope

The Smallest Thing That Proves Everything

Founding Principle: We are not building a CV tool. We are building the verified trust and hiring graph of South Africa — starting with the one thing every professional already needs but nobody has made honest: proof that you actually did what you claim.

Brand note: Operating as ProfileSA until proffile.com and proffile.app domains are acquired (budgeted at ~\$10,000). All architecture, branding, and product decisions are built for the Proffile global identity from day one.

The One Question This MVP Must Answer

"Will South African professionals invite their real managers, colleagues, and clients to leave verified public reviews on their profile — and will those reviewers actually do it?"

Everything in this MVP exists to answer that question. If yes — the graph builds itself. If no — we learn exactly where the friction is and fix it.

The Core Insight (Say It Daily)

LinkedIn indexes what you **claim**. Proffile indexes what you've **proven**.

A job title is a self-reported page.

A verified review from your actual manager is a backlink.

Backlinks beat self-reporting. Always.

This is PageRank for people.

What Is In (Non-Negotiable Core)

1. The Proffile Profile

- User signs up and creates their professional profile
- Fields: Name, headline, city, industry, profile photo
- Work history entries: Company, role, start date, end date (or current), brief description
- Each work history entry has a "Request Review" button
- Profile has a public URL: proffilesa.com/[username]
- Shareable as a link — designed to replace the PDF CV entirely

2. The Verified Review System

- User selects a work history entry and enters the email of a manager, colleague, or client
- System sends a branded review request email to that person
- Reviewer clicks the link — no account required to leave a review
- Review form: Relationship to reviewee (managed them / worked alongside / was their client), star rating (1–5), written review (50–500 characters), skills they can verify (multi-select from a list)
- Once submitted, review is marked "✓ Verified" on the profile
- Reviewer's name, title, and company are shown — they cannot be anonymous
- If the reviewer later creates their own Proofile, their review gains additional weight (verified identity = higher trust signal)

3. Proofile Score (v1)

A single number (0–100) visible on every profile. Calculated from:

- Number of verified reviews (volume)
- Average star rating across all reviews (quality)
- Seniority of reviewers (a CTO's review carries more weight than a peer's)
- Tenure length of verified roles (longer verified employment = more signal)
- Cross-platform verification bonus (GitHub, LinkedIn URL confirmed active)

This is the seed of the PageRank algorithm for people. Simple in MVP. Powerful as the data grows.

4. Skills Verification

- Standard skill tags (Node.js, Python, Project Management, Sales, Design, etc.)
- Skill is "verified" when at least one reviewer has endorsed it via their review
- Verified skills shown with a checkmark and reviewer count: "Node.js ✓ endorsed by 3 verified colleagues"
- Unverified skills shown in a separate section — still visible, clearly labelled as self-reported

5. Cross-Platform Signal Integration (Lightweight MVP Version)

- GitHub: User pastes their GitHub URL — system pulls public contribution stats (repos, commits, stars, years active). Displayed as a verified activity signal, not a self-reported claim.
- LinkedIn: User pastes LinkedIn URL — displayed as "profile exists" link for now. Full integration in Phase 2.

- No OAuth required for MVP — URL-based verification is enough to start

6. Public Profile & Sharing

- Every profile is public by default (can be set to link-only, not indexed)
- Designed to be beautiful when shared — open graph image generated for WhatsApp, Twitter, LinkedIn sharing
- "Share my Profile" button generates a link + a pre-written message: "Instead of sending my CV, here's my verified professional record: [link]"
- QR code for in-person networking (printed on physical cards, shown on phone)

7. Review Request Management

- Dashboard showing all pending review requests
- Status: Sent / Viewed / Completed
- Reminder email auto-sent after 7 days if not completed
- User can resend or cancel any request
- Maximum 3 pending requests per work history entry (prevents spam)

What Is Out (For Now — And Why)

Feature	Why It's Out
Recruiter search / hiring dashboard	Needs a critical mass of profiles first. Phase 2.
ProfileAPI (trust score API)	Enterprise sales cycle. Phase 3.
Job listings or applications	Not a job board. Never become one. Focus.
Salary data	Legal complexity. Phase 3+
Video reviews	Technical overhead. Text reviews first.
Company profiles	Individual trust graph first. Companies second.
Mobile app (iOS/Android)	PWA first. Ship faster.
AI-generated profile suggestions	Phase 2. Core behaviour first.
Fake CV detection service (B2B)	Phase 2 — once we have enough data to power it
Payment / subscription	Free until 10,000 profiles. Growth before revenue.

The One Screen That Must Be Perfect

The Review Request email.

The user creates their profile on Proofile. That's easy — people love making profiles. The hard part is getting their manager to actually click the link and leave a review. If that email is weak, generic, or feels like spam — the graph never builds.

Requirements for this email specifically:

- Subject line must feel personal, not automated: "[Name] is asking you to verify their work at [Company]"
- Body explains clearly: what Proofile is, why it matters, that the reviewer's name will appear publicly (this signals seriousness)
- One clear CTA button: "Leave [Name] a review"
- Mobile-optimised — most reviewers will open on their phone
- Takes less than 3 minutes to complete — shown clearly ("This takes about 2 minutes")
- After submitting: reviewer sees a beautiful confirmation with the option to create their own profile

If only one thing gets polish before launch — it's this email and the review submission flow.

Platform Decision

Progressive Web App (PWA) — not native iOS/Android for MVP

Same reasoning as Parcelicious:

- Faster to ship and iterate
- No App Store delays or approval uncertainty
- Users can install to home screen — feels native
- Switch to React Native in Phase 2

Tech Stack Recommendation:

Layer	Technology
Frontend	React (PWA)
Backend	Node.js + Express or Supabase
Database	PostgreSQL
Auth	Supabase Auth (email + Google)
Email	Resend or Postmark (transactional, high deliverability)
GitHub API	Public REST API (no auth needed for public data)
Hosting	Vercel (frontend) + Railway (backend)
OG Image generation	Vercel OG or Cloudinary
Analytics	PostHog (self-hosted)

SA Market Context — Why This Is Urgent Here

- Problem 1 — Fake CVs** Studies estimate 30%+ of CVs in South Africa contain false information — fabricated degrees, inflated titles, fake reference contacts. Employers know this and still cannot systematically solve it. ProofFileSA makes a fake CV structurally impossible. You cannot fabricate a review from a real person with their own verified identity and their name publicly attached to it.
- Problem 2 — The Hidden Job Market** 70-80% of SA jobs are filled through networks and referrals. Talented people without the right connections — skilled developers from Soweto, designers from Durban who didn't go to the right university — are locked out. ProofFileSA democratises access. A verified record of real work is more powerful than a network you were born into.
- Problem 3 — Degree Fetishism** SA employers over-index on formal qualifications. A Wits CS dropout with 5 verified reviews from senior engineers and 800 GitHub contributions is more hireable than a degree holder with no proof of actual work. ProofFileSA is the infrastructure that makes that argument provable, not just sayable.

Target User (Be Specific)

Primary — The Career Builder South African professional, 22-35, working in tech, marketing, finance, design, or creative industries. Has changed jobs at least once. Suspects their CV doesn't

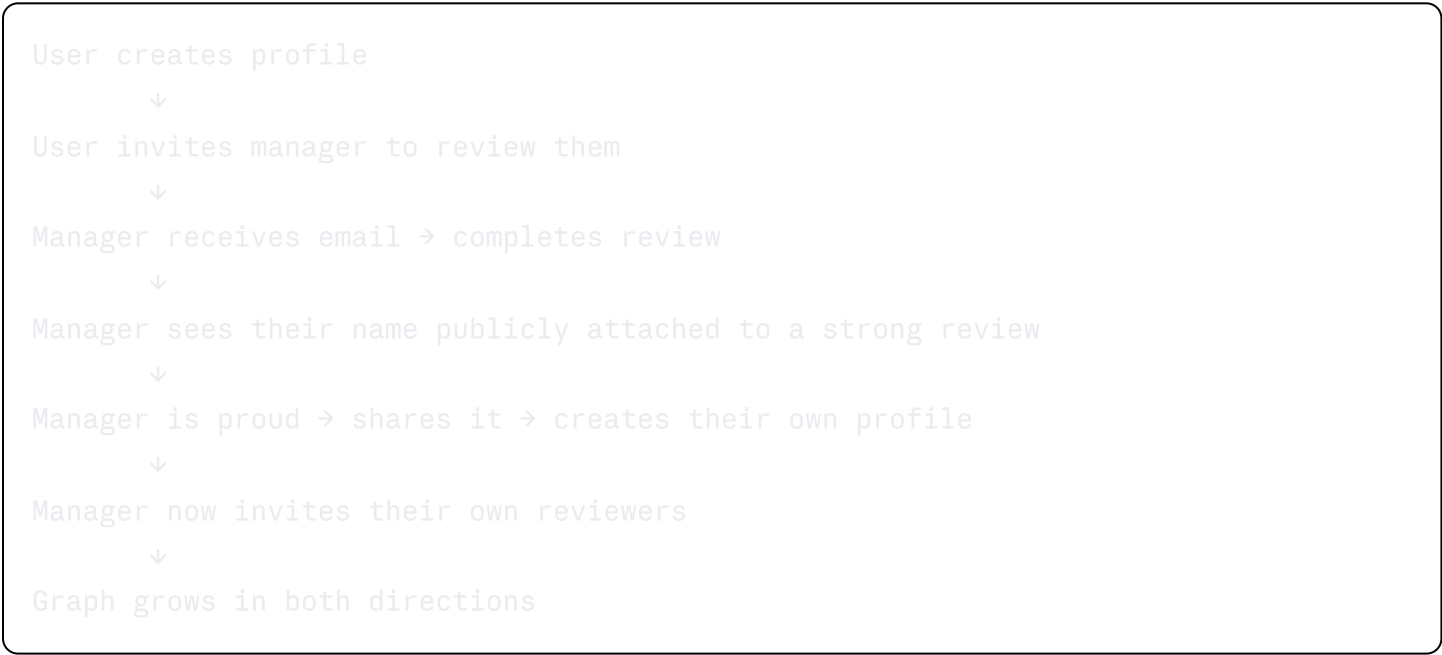
do them justice. Would love to show their real track record but has no credible way to do it. Already uses LinkedIn but knows it's a self-reported fiction.

Secondary — The Hiring Manager HR manager or team lead, 28-45. Has been burned by a fake CV or a candidate who interviewed brilliantly but couldn't do the job. Would pay for a signal they could actually trust. Currently pays LinkedIn R8,000-R15,000/month and gets keyword matching, not truth.

The Viral Growth User — The Proud Manager A manager who has built a great team and wants to publicly vouch for the people they've developed. When a manager leaves a review, they share it too — "I just verified [Name]'s work on ProofileSA — this person is exceptional." That's a two-sided viral loop.

The Viral Mechanic

Unlike Parcelicious where the user posts content themselves, ProofileSA has a built-in two-sided viral loop:



Every review request is a marketing touch for someone who has never heard of Proofile. The product markets itself through the review request email — every single time.

Success Metrics for MVP (First 90 Days)

Metric	Target	What It Proves
Profiles created	2,000	Demand for the product
Review requests sent	5,000	Users believe in the value enough to ask
Review completion rate	40%+	The review flow is not too painful

Metric	Target	What It Proves
Verified reviews published	2,000+	The graph is actually building
Profiles shared externally	30% of users	People are using it as a CV replacement
Reviewers who create own profile	20%	The viral loop works
D30 retention	30%+	People keep their profile updated

Launch Strategy (No Budget Required)

Week 1 — The Founder's Story Post on LinkedIn and Twitter/X: "I'm a Wits CS dropout. My CV says that. But my GitHub has 500 contributions, two managers who'd vouch for me in a heartbeat, and clients who got results. The CV system can't show any of that. So I built something that can."

This is not marketing copy. This is your real story. It will travel.

Week 2-4 — The Founding 100 Personally reach out to 100 SA professionals with strong reputations but weak LinkedIn presence — developers active on GitHub, designers with good portfolios, marketers known by reputation. Offer them a founding profile. Help them set it up. Get their first reviews in place.

Month 2 — The Manager Campaign Target SA hiring managers and team leads specifically. Proposition: "Your team's reputation is only as visible as their CVs. Give them something credible." When a manager publicly vouches for five people on ProofileSA, they become a node in the graph — and they bring their whole network.

Month 3 — The Bootcamp & University Channel WeThinkCode, HyperionDev, CodeSpace, Umuzi — bootcamp graduates are exactly the people Proofile is built for. They have real skills and no formal credentials. Partner with bootcamps to offer every graduate a ProofileSA profile as part of their graduation package.

Build Timeline (Realistic)

Week	Milestone
1-2	Wireframes. Profile page and review form to pixel perfection.
3-4	Auth, profile creation, work history entries
5-6	Review request system — email sending, review submission form
7	Verified review display on profile. Proofile Score v1 calculation

Week	Milestone
8	Skills verification layer
9	GitHub signal integration (URL-based, public API)
10	Public profile, OG image generation, QR code
11	Review request dashboard (pending / completed / resend)
12	PWA packaging, performance, mobile optimisation
13	Soft launch — 100 founding profiles
14-16	Iterate, fix friction, prepare public launch

The Conspiracy Beneath the MVP

Nobody creating their profile in Phase 1 needs to know this. But you do.

Every verified review builds edges in a graph:

- Who managed whom (hierarchy)
- Who worked alongside whom (peer network)
- Who was a client of whom (market network)
- Which companies produce the most trusted talent
- Which skills are actually proven vs. which are claimed

By the time you have 10,000 verified profiles and 30,000 verified reviews, you have the most accurate map of professional South Africa ever assembled. Not the stated map (LinkedIn). The real one.

That graph is worth more than the profile product built on top of it.

You are not building a CV replacement. You are building the verified professional trust graph of South Africa — with a beautiful profile page as the trojan horse.

Document version: 1.0 — ProofleSA Founding Session Brand note: ProofleSA is the operating name until proofle.com + proofle.app domains are acquired Next document: Product Requirements Document (PRD)